

Investment Manager Due Diligence Questionnaire — Completed Draft

Manager: Chester Asset Management Pty Ltd

Product: Chester High Conviction Fund (APIR: OPS7755AU)

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Business

Applies to the investment manager with direct responsibility for investment decision-making.

Business inception date

Status: Generated from knowledge base

Chester Asset Management was formed in 2017. The Chester High Conviction Fund (CHCF) launched in April 2017, run on the same basis as the predecessor SGH Australia Plus Fund (a 3.5-year track record). Lead Portfolio Manager Rob Tucker has managed money on the same approach since 2005, including five years running the HSBC Australian Country Funds from Hong Kong.

Business ownership and structure

Status: Generated from knowledge base

Chester Asset Management Pty Ltd is a boutique Australian equities manager established in April 2017 by Rob Tucker and Anthony Kavanagh. The business is 100% employee-owned by its three Portfolio Managers — Rob Tucker, Anthony Kavanagh and Luke Howard — with no external or institutional shareholders, and no changes to the ownership structure are planned. CAM outsources non-core functions by design: Copia Investment Partners Ltd provides Responsible Entity, distribution and administration services for the Chester High Conviction Fund, leaving the five-person investment team focused solely on portfolio management.

References: Diversa · sheet 2.1.4 · FSC CHCF pp.23–26

Has ownership or structure changed in the last 5 years?

Status: Generated from knowledge base

No changes to business ownership or structure over the last five years. The business remains well-funded and committed to further growth.

Total firm-wide FUM (Firm Wide, in AUD)

Status: Manually validated

Total firm-wide FUM was A\$2,310 million as at 31 May 2026 (manually confirmed). Australian equities is the firm's sole asset class. Recent history: A\$933.82m (31 Dec 2023); A\$1,341.85m (31 Dec 2024); A\$2,234.43m (31 Dec 2025).

References: Diversa · sheet 1.2.6

Is the business a single-strategy business?

Status: Generated from knowledge base

CAM is a boutique Australian equities manager applying a consistent, high-conviction philosophy across its offering — effectively a single-strategy business with variations around the same core approach. It manages three products: Chester High Conviction (retail, all-cap, led by Rob Tucker); Chester Mid-Cap (mandate, same philosophy, led by Rob Tucker); and Chester Opportunities (wholesale, small-cap, led by Anthony Kavanagh).

Licensing & Compliance

Licensing, regulatory standing and governance of the manager and Responsible Entity.

AFSL / Corporate Authorised Representative & special conditions

Status: Generated from knowledge base

Chester Asset Management Pty Ltd (CAM) operates as a Corporate Authorised Representative of Copia Investment Partners Ltd (ABN 22 092 872 056), holder of Australian Financial Services Licence No. 229316.

Copia also acts as Responsible Entity for the Chester High Conviction Fund. A copy of the licence is attached. The AFSL contains no special conditions beyond those standard for licensees of its class; authorisations cover dealing in, and advising on, interests in managed investment schemes and operating registered schemes. Copia oversees CAM's authorised-representative activities under its licensee monitoring and supervision program.

References: 2 Copia AFSL.pdf · FSC CHCF p.1

Regulatory standing

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

No ASIC enforceable undertakings, reportable breaches or non-routine regulator interactions in the past five years.

References: Diversa · Q2.5.4

Governance & board oversight

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Chester's governance, risk and compliance frameworks — including the internal-controls environment — are overseen by the Copia (CIPL) Board: Bruce Loveday (Chairman), Sam Cole (Director), Sally McDow (Director) and Michael Voskresensky (Company Secretary). No members of the investment team have operational duties; the front-office function operates independently of the back office, which is provided by the Responsible Entity.

Internal controls assurance (GS007)

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Independently assured under GS007 / ASAE 3402 Type 2 for both Copia and Chester for FY2025, each with a signed audit opinion.

References: Copia GS007 2025 · Chester GS007 2025

People

The investment manager and team with direct responsibility for investment decision-making.

Business headcount and change over three years

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

A five-person investment team (5 in 2025, 5 in 2024, 3 — briefly 4 — in 2023). All five are investment professionals; operations, distribution, marketing and administration are provided by Copia, which employs 23 staff across Victoria, New South Wales and Queensland.

Key investment staff & biographies

Status: [Resolved via information request](#)

Rob Tucker — Managing Director & Portfolio Manager (26 years' industry experience). Anthony Kavanagh — Portfolio Manager (16 years). Luke Howard — Portfolio Manager. All three are based in Melbourne and are co-owners of the business.

References: Fund Manager bios.docx · FSC CHCF pp.23–26

Remuneration & alignment

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Portfolio Managers are remunerated through a base salary plus a performance component tied to the investment outcomes of the Fund. Alignment with investors is reinforced by meaningful co-investment in the Fund by the investment team and by 100% employee ownership of the business.

Succession & key-person risk

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Key-person risk is mitigated across the three Portfolio Managers, who share the same philosophy and process; each strategy has a designated back-up decision-maker. Succession planning is in place for the key investment figureheads.

Investment process & philosophy

Investment philosophy (as it relates to this product)

Status: Generated from knowledge base

Chester's philosophy is grounded in the view that equity markets are not perfectly efficient, and that disciplined fundamental research can exploit mispricing over the medium term. For the Chester High Conviction Fund this is expressed through the team's Quality–Valuation–Edge (QVE) framework: each position must demonstrate business quality (assessed across operating, financial and corporate-governance risk), trade at a discount to assessed intrinsic value, and offer an identifiable analytical edge not reflected in consensus. The Fund is benchmark-unaware and concentrated — 25 to 40 stocks drawn primarily from the S&P/ASX 300, with up to 10% in non-index (pre-IPO) names and up to 20% cash — and targets outperformance of the S&P/ASX 300 Accumulation Index of 5% p.a. over rolling three-year periods, with expected tracking error of 5–10%. Equal emphasis is placed on minimising capital drawdown: the team treats avoidance of permanent capital loss as the most reliable driver of long-term outperformance. The approach has been applied consistently since the Fund's inception in April 2017 — and by lead Portfolio Manager Rob Tucker on the same basis since 2005.

References: FSC CHCF · Q13.2 (pp.2–3) · FSC CHCF · Q13.7 (pp.4–8)

Overarching style

Status: Generated from knowledge base

High-conviction, active, with a flexible style bias. The Fund's emphasis on free-cash-flow generation gives it generally growth attributes, but valuation support must always be evident to ensure an appropriate margin of safety. Chester will also exploit more contrarian ideas where the market has mispriced companies by extrapolating a poor near-term outlook.

Research process & idea generation

Status: Generated from knowledge base

Research is conducted in-house. Ideas are generated through screening to narrow the investable universe and bottom-up fundamental research against the QVE framework, supported by global, regional and sector context. A devil's-advocate process challenges positions when analysts present ideas.

Position sizing & portfolio construction

Status: Generated from knowledge base

The portfolio is concentrated at 25–40 holdings, sized by conviction and QVE score rather than benchmark weight, with up to 10% in non-index (pre-IPO) names and up to 20% cash. Analysts prepare downside scenarios at the stock level, and positions that fall materially are re-underwritten against the original thesis.

References: FSC CHCF · Q13.7 (pp.4–8)

Is the strategy benchmark-aware?

Status: Generated from knowledge base

The strategy is benchmark-unaware. The S&P/ASX 300 is used as a reference for performance measurement, not as a constraint on portfolio construction.

Performance & Portfolio

Benchmark, objectives, fees and capacity for the product.

Performance benchmark

Status: Generated from knowledge base

S&P/ASX 300 Accumulation Index.

Return objective

Status: Generated from knowledge base

To outperform the S&P/ASX 300 Accumulation Index by 5% p.a. (before fees) over rolling three-year periods.

References: FSC CHCF · Q13.4 (p.3)

Risk objective

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

No formal risk objective; the Fund is designed for investors seeking to grow wealth while preserving capital, with expected tracking error of 5–10%.

Fee structure

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Base management fee of 0.95% p.a. A performance fee of 15% applies to outperformance above the benchmark, accrued daily and payable quarterly, subject to a high-water mark (estimated at ~0.45% p.a. based on the five-year average).

Strategy capacity

Status: [Manually validated](#)

Estimated capacity is approximately A\$2.9 billion for the retail strategy. Capacity was last reviewed in March 2026.

Use of derivatives

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

The Fund does not invest in derivatives and is not geared.

Operations & Risk

Insurance, service providers, risk controls and continuity.

Certificates of currency for each policy of insurance

Status: [Resolved via information request](#)

The Manager maintains the following insurance program, placed with Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd.

Certificates of currency for all five policies are attached.

Policy	Insurer	Limit	Expiry
Professional Indemnity	Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd	\$10m	26 Oct 2026
Directors & Officers	Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd	\$10m	26 Oct 2026
Electronic & Computer Crime	Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd	\$2m	14 Sep 2026
Fraud	Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd	\$20m	26 Oct 2026
Cybersecurity	Chubb Insurance Australia Ltd	\$2m	14 Sep 2026

References: *Chubb Combined CoC 2026.pdf*

Key service providers

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Responsible Entity: Copia Investment Partners Ltd. Custodian: State Street (master custodian) and HSBC (sub-custodian). Fund auditor: EY.

Risk controls & oversight

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

Risk is controlled through stock, sector and cash limits, with no leverage. Portfolio risk and compliance are overseen by Copia's risk and compliance function independently of the investment team; stress tests and scenario analysis are applied to the portfolio periodically.

Business continuity & disaster recovery

Status: [Generated from knowledge base](#)

A documented Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery plan is maintained as part of the firm's policy framework.

References: *BCP & DR Plan*